

Your own stressors and sabotages will be different. But the important thing is to recognise them and come up with a plan both for when they do, and for before they even first appear.

What sort of plan do I put in place to limit my stressors and sabotaging behaviour? I lean into a routine of meditating, laying off the chocolate, making sure my breathing is deep and not shallow and exercising regularly. I also make sure I'm having weekly date nights with my husband, getting a weekly laughter dose with my bestie Rod and going for weekly lunchtime walks with my work wife, Lauren. I commit to monthly catch-ups with my business pack and quarterly dinners with my old LBD tribe, and I commit to not working one full day a weekend.

Now, this all might seem silly and very non-financial, but I can spot when I'm at risk of stress and financial sabotage when two or more of these things stop happening. These routines are like my canary in the coal mine so I can push the emergency button quickly and easily as soon as I notice them.

For me, pressing the emergency button looks like this: I instantly commit to a 30-day financial detox where I can't buy any new wants for a whole month. I immediately book in to my diary a long weekend of nothing but reading and sleeping, where I turn off my phone. If necessary, I make an emergency appointment with a therapist, and recently I've started doing the Broad Place High Vibrational Living Challenge, which is fourteen days of no chocolate, no wine, no coffee, moving daily, meditating twice-daily and practising gratitude daily.

But I've also created a suite of financial habits which means I don't have to hit that emergency stop button as often. Creating a suite of habits for my Financial Phenotype such as the ones I talked about in [Chapter 13](#) means I have an automated, unconscious basis for how to financially behave.

Now it's your turn.

First, start by looking at your general environment and thinking about the great general non-financial habits that reduce your overall stress levels. These might be moving for 30 minutes each day, reducing your sugar intake, stopping for 15 minutes and mindfully enjoying your daily latte, a weekly game of touch football with good friends or daily meditation. Next, look at your financial habits and for patterns that emerge during times